

Russell Dudek

INTERVIEW THESIS BRIEF

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Interview thesis

The next phase is not more AI use cases. It is a repeatable conversion from AI capability into stronger consulting work, better economics, protected judgment, and justified scale.

What the role is really solving

Enterprise AI capacity and identified opportunities do not automatically produce changed consulting delivery. The missing system is business-owned portfolio activation: prioritization, practice redesign, technical translation, adoption, measurement, and scale decisions.

Why now

Baker Tilly is expanding, integrating, and publicly investing in governed AI systems around professional expertise. The strategic opportunity is to make that investment compound across Consulting without flattening practice-specific work or professional judgment.

Candidate thesis

AI becomes a consulting advantage only when the work, economics, judgment model, and adoption system change together.

Immediate contribution

Establish a transparent portfolio mechanism, sharpen business-to-technology requests, create measurable pilot-to-scale criteria, and mobilize practice ownership.

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The operating argument

The Consulting AI leader should function as a value-realization owner and a demanding business counterpart—not a shadow CTO.

1 Start with consulting economics

Define the service outcome and the expected change in quality, speed, capacity, pricing, leverage, utilization, risk, or growth before the technical solution becomes the center of gravity.

2 Translate the real workflow

Specify sources, handoffs, exceptions, human authority, client confidentiality, reusable knowledge, integrations, and adoption burden—not just model features.

3 Challenge the proposal

Test estimates, hidden assumptions, build-versus-configure choices, integration dependencies, evaluation plans, operational ownership, and what limitations mean for Consulting.

4 Make scale an evidence decision

Use role-based adoption, output quality, exceptions, rework, cycle time, confidence, reuse, and economic consequences to decide whether to scale, redesign, pause, or stop.

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Interview strategy

Lead with the rare integrated fit; handle the strongest objection through evidence and a practical working session, not defensive disclaimers.

Strongest plausible concern

Russell has not held a formal AI leadership role inside a national accounting partnership. The relevant question is whether his operating pattern transfers into a complex multi-practice professional-services environment.

Evidence-based response

- Direct AI-first operating transformation spanning technical and business systems.
- Applied AI portfolio frameworks, agentic workflow patterns, governance, evaluation, and human review.
- Scaled operating mechanisms at Amazon.
- Technical credibility and control discipline in high-reliability engineering/manufacturing.
- Executive, public-private, commercial, and cross-functional translation experience.

Working-session offer

Use one representative consulting workflow to build a bounded value-conversion case: economic claim, workflow redesign, authority model, technical request, adoption plan, evidence standard, and scale decision.

Executive questions

1. Which consulting practices feel the greatest pressure to change their delivery model now—and why?
2. Where do identified use cases currently lose momentum: value clarity, platform capacity, data, risk, practice ownership, or adoption?
3. How are practice leaders expected to make tradeoffs between labor efficiency, pricing, capacity, quality, and growth?
4. What would make technical teams say Consulting is an exceptionally clear business counterpart?
5. Where must professional judgment remain visible even when AI can complete more of the work?
6. What evidence would cause leadership to stop a popular initiative?
7. How should this role balance national consistency with practice-specific differentiation?
8. Twelve months from now, what operating behavior would prove the strategy is real?